DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

This project report presents my work as a Student Digital Ambassador. It required completing a series of tasks designed to develop essential digital skills, which included creating an awareness infographic, building a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practicing email etiquette, and understanding cybercrime.

Each task was carefully assigned to highlight different aspects of digital literacy, enabling me to connect theoretical knowledge with practical application. Through this project, I acquired practical knowledge and experience with various digital tools and developed a deeper understanding of the importance of safe, ethical, and professional behavior in the digital world.

Overall, this project provides a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and helps prepare students for academic and professional success.

TASK 1 – CREATE A DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

For Task 1, I was required to create a one-page visual resource to help my batchmates understand the meaning of digital literacy and its necessity. I designed a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic using Canva, which I found highly convenient due to its user-friendly interface and its wide range of design templates.

The infographic provides a clear, concise, and visually engaging overview of key digital literacy concepts.

TOOLS USED

To complete this assignment, I used Canva, an application that has made it easy to create infographics using various icons, layouts and templates. I used it to create an infographic on digital literacy awareness.

WHAT MY DESIGN SHOWS

The infographic includes sections explaining what digital literacy is, why is it important, how to check information, safe internet practice, useful digital tools and digital footprint. I kept the content simple and easy to understand so that it is easy for everyone, even beginners, to understand.

REFLECTION

While designing the infographic, I enjoyed arranging the content into different sections using different colours and shapes to make it easier to read. Since I am already familiar with Canva, the process was smooth and enjoyable. This task helped me understand how effective visual communication can be in raising awareness about important topics like digital literacy.

TASK 2 – BUILD YOUR STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

Task 2 required setting up digital portfolios to represent my skills, work and achievements as a Student Digital Ambassador.

PLATFORMS USED

GitHub – A platform used to store and manage projects, especially codes and it also allows me to document my learning and showcase my work.

LinkedIn – It is a professional networking platform where I can connect with peers and industry professionals to stay updated on opportunities and to present my academic and career achievements.

Kaggle – It is a data science and machine learning platform, where people can use datasets, practice machine learning and participate in competitions.

PLANS

As a first year Electronics and Communication Engineering student, I plan to use these three platforms consistently over the next three years. On GitHub, I aim to upload more new projects related to electronics, embedded systems, communication and programming. On LinkedIn, I aim to maintain a professional profile to share achievements and build meaningful connections. On Kaggle, I aim to explore data analysis, machine learning and also to develop my skills.

Overall, these three platforms will help my professional and academic growth so that I have a strong foundation for future career prospects in the field of electronics and communication.

TASK 3 – EXPLORE CODING AND COLLABORATIVE PLATFORMS

For Task 3, I explored a range of digital platforms used in educational and professional contexts to document my activities and reflect on their purpose and features.
I used HackerRank and Google Forms to explore coding and collaboration platforms more effectively.

PLATFORMS EXPLORED

On Google Forms, I designed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz." The platform, having a user-friendly interface, enabled me to create a structured quiz with various question types, which included multiple-choice, checkboxes and short-answer questions. The quiz created by me focuses on fundamental aspects of digital literacy.

On HackerRank, I created an account and achieved Badge 1 by completing beginner-level coding challenges. This platform enhances programming and logical thinking skills by making you practice consistently. It also provides progress tracking which helps in building confidence and improving performance in coding.

REFLECTION

Overall, these platforms will significantly help my academic development by strengthening my coding skills and facilitating effective collaboration. In future, I plan to consistently practice coding problems on HackerRank and use Google Forms for surveys, quizzes, and academic projects, which will help improve both my technical and communication skills.

TASK 4 – DRAFT A PROFESSIONAL EMAIL AND ETIQUETTE GUIDE

Task 4 wanted me to focus on understanding and applying professional digital ammunication.

PART A –

I drafted two formal emails, one requesting an assignment extension and another expressing interest in a summer internship, while adhering to appropriate email structure, tone, and etiquette. This activity helped me to understand the importance of subject lines, formal language and well-organized content in professional communication.

SAMPLE EMAILS DRAFTED

Email 1 – A formal email addressed to a professor requesting for an extension on a project deadline, using appropriate tone, a clear subject line and a sign-off.

Email 2 - A professionally structured email to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity while adhering to email etiquettes.

EMAIL ETIQUETTE CHECKLIST

I made a checklist consisting of 12 rules covering:

- Subject line clarity – Always specific and never left blank
- Greeting format – Differentiating between formal (Dear Mr./Ms.) and semi-formal (Hi [Name]) greetings
- Structure – Following a sequence of opening, body, and closing
- Tone – Maintain a professional and neutral style, free from slang or emojis
- Attachments – Clearly name and reference them within the email
- Response time – Maintain a prompt reply window of 24–48 hours

PART B –

I created a social media checklist emphasizing responsible online behaviour which included key do's and don'ts for students. This task helped me understand how poor digital communication can result in misunderstandings and missed opportunities.

Understanding proper email etiquette and responsible social media usage is crucial for maintaining a professional image.

This task enhanced my awareness of effective and responsible digital communication, which will be very valuable throughout my academic and professional journey.

REFLECTION

A common example of poor digital communication is when a student sends an email to a professor using informal language and without a clear subject line, such as "Hey sir, send me

notes fast." This may appear disrespectful and unclear, thereby reducing the chances of a constructive response. This situation can be improved by adopting a professional tone, a clear subject line, polite language and ending with a respectful closing.

Overall, these tasks helped me understand the importance of effective communication and digital awareness. I will use these principles in future to avoid misunderstandings and ensure smooth and professional interactions in both academic and professional environments.

TASK 5 – CYBER AWARENESS CASE STUDY AND PREVENTION GUIDE

Task 5 required me to investigate a real-world cybercrime case study and produce a write-up alongside a personal prevention checklist.

CASE STUDY – SYNTHETIC IDENTITY BREACH

While researching different cybercrimes, I came across identity theft and how common it is becoming in this era of AI. In the cases, the criminals acquire your SSNs, biometric data and financial credentials to commit fraud. Nowadays, they are even using AI to create fake synthetic identities. They open small credit card using this fake person and pay bills consistently for few months to make the person look responsible and real. After the credit reaches a high limit, the thief maxes out the card on expensive things like electronics and disappears. The user only finds out months later when a debt collector calls them about a person whose existence is completely unknown to them.

ANALYSIS

The case study showed that mainly people of age group 40-49, seniors and minors are exploited. The criminals steal the identity of others to commit the crime leaving behind no trace to find them because of which the victims are left in a financial crisis, mental health problems and legal burdens. Some prevention methods to save your identity from being stolen are – enabling Multi-Factor Authentication, monitoring minors and not using public Wi-Fi.

Overall, it shows that lack of awareness and prevention is the main reason that such attacks succeed, leading to identity theft.

REFLECTION

This task was very informative and increased my awareness about online safety.

I will stay cautious while using my bank accounts and also while sharing personal details. I will also spread awareness about this to my family and friends so that they can avoid such a hassle and stay safe.

Overall, this task helped me understand the importance of being cautious and responsible while using digital platforms.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, this project greatly improved my understanding and awareness of digital literacy. It made me grasp valuable knowledge and hands-on experience in applying digital skills in real-world situations. Through a number of tasks, I developed the ability to use digital tools effectively, maintain a professional online presence and communicate responsibly in digital environments. I gained awareness of cyber safety, online fraud and the importance of protecting my personal information.

Each task played a vital role in strengthening key skills such as problem-solving, communication and critical thinking. Creating an infographic improved my visual presentation skills, while creating digital portfolios helped build my professional identity. The coding and collaboration activities improved my technical skills and teamwork abilities, encouraging consistent practice. Furthermore, the email etiquette and cybercrime sections deepened my understanding of responsible digital behaviour.

Overall, this experience has motivated me to use digital tools more effectively and responsibly. I am confident that these skills will continue to support my academic journey and future career in engineering.

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- LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com

- Kaggle - https://www.kaggle.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal (India) - https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Online articles and study materials on digital literacy and cyber safety
- Class notes and course material.